No” to the United States more favourably. India, on the other hand, has moved steadily toward closer strategic partnership with the United States. This new closeness to the United States could become a liability for India in its Iran rivalry with Beijing. India will need US understanding of India’s need for strategic autonomy to effectively play the new Persian game.

Notes

1 Go is a different game from chess. The end goal of chess is to defeat the opponent, while the objective in Go is to make all-round gains on the board so as to emerge with a larger number of points.

2 Garver, John W. (2016) *China’s Quest: The History of the Foreign Relations of the People’s Republic of China*, New York: Oxford University Press, p. 571.

3 On India’s balancing between Tehran and Washington, see Fair, C. Christine (2010) “Indo-Iranian Relations: What Prospects for Transformation?,” in Sumit Ganguly, ed., *India’s Foreign Policy; Retrospect and Prospect*, New York: Oxford University Press, pp. 132–154; Fair, C. Christine (2007) “India and Iran: New Delhi’s Balancing Act,” *Washington Quarterly*, vol. 23, no. 3 (Summer), pp. 145–159; Fair, C. Christine (2004) “Indo-Iranian Relations: Prospects for Bilateral Cooperation Post-9–11,” *The “Strategic Partnership” between India and Iran*, Woodrow Wilson Center Asian Program Special Report, no. 120 (April), pp. 6–18; Pant, Harsh V. and Julie M. Super (2013) “Balancing Rivals: India’s Tightrope between Iran and the United States,” *Asia Policy*, National Bureau of Research, no. 15 (January), pp. 69–88.

4 Garver, John W. (2006) *China and Iran; Ancient Partners in a Post-Imperial World*, Seattle: University of Washington Press, pp. 153–165.

5 For a detailed account of China’s role in terminating the Iran-Iraq war, see Garver, John W. (2013) “China-Iran: Cautious Friendship with America’s Rival,” *China Report*, Special edition, vol. 49, no. 1 (February), pp. 69–88.

6 This section adumbrates a detailed investigation of China’s role in the Iran nuclear negotiations; see Garver, John W. (2018) “China and the Iran Nuclear Negotiations: Beijing’s Mediation,” in James Reardon-Anderson, ed., *The Red Star and the Crescent: China and the Middle East*, Georgetown University Press, Washington, DC, pp. 123–148.

7 “Iran’s leader lauds Iran-China 25-year strategic relations agreement.” Op cit.

8 Ji, Lu (2015) “Lishi yu xianshijian guo xia de zhong ye hezuo: jiyu yilangren dui ‘yi dai yi lu’ renshi he jiedu” (Deciphering Iranian’s Understanding of ‘One Belt One Road: Sino-Iranian Cooperation under History and Pragmatism), *Xiya*